

Council Meeting
May 29, 2024
Page 1

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, May 29, 2023, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne - Absent
Ward II Councilor Brian Zutter
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden arrived at 6:45 pm
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway - Absent
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Yoshi Manale, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

None.

CITIZEN’S FORUM

None.

NEW BUSINESS

Parks

Director Martin started by thanking the Council for ability to come back to present. Director Martin noted there are two lines he would like to address. The first being the Rent and leases line and would like to amend this to a 15-passenger vehicle with air conditioning. The current vehicle has many issues. Based on the 10-year plan this vehicle is next up on the capital replacement plan.

Director Martin was quoted \$75,000.00 for a 15-passenger vehicle with air conditioning. The City Manager recommends amending the line to \$52,373.96 this would be a 5-year finance plan with a 5% interest rate.

The Second line item is Capital Escrow, and would like to amend this line to zero. The overall budget numbers would now be amended to \$492,747.96.

Norm Blouin, Ward 3, would like to see Council get broader on equipment, with today's prices Mr. Blouin would like to see what leases would cost.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to tentatively approve the Parks Budget for \$ 492,747.96

Koloski – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 5-0

Communication 911/Police Budget

Chief Wilmot presented the Communication 911 and Police Budget

A moment of silence was held for the late Captain Stan Andrews.

Chief Wilmot started by stating the Police Department's Mission statement, and then played the new recruitment video.

Communication 911

Chief Wilmot stated there are two part time employees. One being Dispatcher St. Pierre who works to fill our records management roll, and the second part time communications specialist who fills in when needed. Chief explained there is someone who was recently extended a conditional offer of employment to. Chief then bragged about dispatch being the unsung heroes to the department.

Chief Wilmot noted future updates in the center through the congressional direct spending application was approved and noted just today he received an email from the Department of Justice indicating solicitation is ready to being.

Continues to contract with Sullivan County Sherrif's office the town of Cornish, Unity, and Lempster to provide dispatching services. Chief Wilmot stated the budget is fair and balanced.

Mayor Girard noted the telephone line item was budgeted 10K, and asked if plans changed.

Chief Wilmot noted the City is changing telephone providers for land lines and explained the Police Departments Telephone service between cell phones, AT&T, air cards through Verizon,

the copper lines for 911, and then other lines the PD currently pays \$1000.00 a month for all telephone services, and then on top of that is about \$1200.00 for the telephone recording software. Chief Wilmot noted it would be a goal to add additional cell phones to the department. Chief Wilmot also stated all phones, and phone lines are paid out of Budget 420.

Councilor Koloski suggested moving the number up accordingly, and suggested \$16,000.00.

By consensus the City Council agrees to change line to \$16,000.00.

Norm Blouin, ward 3 – asked if there was an availability to lease this equipment.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to tentatively approve the Communications 911 Budget for \$ 691,216.00.

**Koloski – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hayden – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 6-0**

Police

Chief Wilmot presented the Police Budget, and stated some notable items were health insurance, there is a cost increase as two positions that were not funded that were supposed to be was put back in correctly this year. Regular pay, contractual 6% raises for members of CBU, Part time increase rationale- increase reliance on part time officers to cover shifts, Detail work, and Consulting services which is decreasing.

Councilor Hayden asked about the ammunition budget line and asked why are we currently at half that budget.

Chief replied there are typically two large purchases of ammunition a year, and will be making another purchase soon.

Councilor Zutter questioned the training line.

Chief Wilmot responded the demands on outside trainings have increased, and NH police academy training used to have some free training but not anymore.

Norm Blouin, Ward 3, suggested solar powered flashing lights as others are not obeying the speed limits.

Chief Wilmot noted the office of Highway Safety does offer this equipment, and the intention is to apply.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Hayden to tentatively approve the Police Budget for \$ 3,280,678.00.

**Koloski – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hayden – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 6-0**

Sanitation (Transfer Station)

Director Gleeson presented the Sanitation Department and noted it has a private company running the Transfer Station.

Director Gleeson highlighted items of note such as Building Facility M&R which is a place holder for maintenance. Municipal solid waste which are road side debris, clean up days, and the increase was tire day. Landfill monitoring this is a contractual rate, and Landfill Mowing is \$5,000.00 and is done in the fall and spring.

A motion was made by Council Limoges and seconded by Councilor Zutter to tentatively approve the sanitation Budget for \$ 26,500.00.

**Koloski – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hayden – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 6-0**

Cemetery

Director Gleeson presented the Cemetery Budget and noted Fund 471 has limited changes this year.

Director Gleeson noted the correction of the disbursement of employees as there was a non-caption of a truck driver last year.

Councilor Zutter suggested changing the temp and seasonal line to \$10,000.00.

By consensus the City Council agrees to change line item.

A motion was made by Councilor Zutter and seconded by Assistant to tentatively approve the Cemetery Budget for \$ 248,613.00.

**Koloski – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hayden – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 6-0**

Streets & Roads (Highway)

Director Gleeson presented the Streets and Roads Budget and explained the department does Grading, Paving, Patching, Sweeping, Line-painting, Sidewalk improvements, Catch basin repairs, and Snow removal operations in winter.

Director Gleeson also explained the administration pay break-down, Staffing levels and operation initiatives, the training of two new foremen, in house CDL training program with the Fire Department, Salt Prescription which is a spreading technology, and asset tracking.

Director Gleeson reviewed the paving plan, and future projects like drainage work on lower Belding, Tyler St. culvert relocation, and the planning phase for twin culverts.

Councilor Koloski asked if the contract for seal coating was city wide or designated, Director Gleeson replied it was designated.

Councilor Koloski asked if it would it make sense to have our own seal coating equipment and do the work.

Director Gleeson replied that would significantly increase OT and pay rates.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to tentatively approve the Streets and Roads Budget for \$ 3,978,753.00.

**Koloski – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hayden – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 6-0**

Municipal Complex (Maintenance)

Director Gleeson gave a presentation for Municipal Complex starting by reading the mission statement.

Director Gleeson stated there were a few notable items such as M&R Cleaning has a new figure of \$98,660.00 from \$40,000.00 and a zero balance in the part time line which was previously \$58,240.00 in the budget book. This adjustment is to allow for more cleaning and maintenance to assist the Maintenance Supervisor by adding to the current contract.

Director Gleeson noted projects such as atrium floor upgrades, carpet removal, Step Repair, automatic door repair, fire alarm upgrade completion, and temporary alleyway ramp.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Zutter to tentatively approve the Municipal Complex Budget for \$ 587,930.00.

**Koloski – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hayden – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 6-0**

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL
None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 8:57 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to adjourn.

**Koloski – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hayden – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 6-0**

Respectfully Submitted,

Council Meeting
May 29, 2024
Page 7

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council